

**Gita Gopinath: First Deputy Managing Director, International Monetary Fund**

# *The challenge to build resilience fuelled by a world that demands it*

She's young, she's pretty and she's full of vim and vigour. American-Indian economist Gita Gopinath has had her fair share of challenges and learnings as the first Deputy Managing Director of the International Monetary Fund (IMF), since 21 January 2022. Stepping away from these duties in August 2025 she returns to Harvard as professor to joust with her students through debates and exchange ideas on campus. She looks forward to pushing the research frontier in international finance and macroeconomics to address global challenges, and to training the next generation of economists, she said in a statement.

In her opening remarks at a recent conference on "Sri Lanka's Road to Recovery: Debt and Governance" in Colombo, Gopinath pointed out that nations worldwide are being tested by shocks that are more frequent and more complex with the global economy facing powerful crosscurrents—slowing growth, rising tariffs, and a rapidly changing global economic order alongside profound uncertainty. "The challenge for all of us is to build resilience in a world that demands it," she said.

Earlier in May she talked about the US effective tariff rate, since April, which has increased to levels last seen over a hundred years ago, and how the uncertainty surrounding trade policy and geopolitics has surged. The economic effects of these developments she pointed out are expected to be sizable. No country, in her view, will emerge unscathed from these overtures.

As First Deputy Managing Director of IMF Gopinath spearheaded the Fund's work of senior staff, represented the Fund at the G7 and G20, maintained high-level contacts with member governments and Board members, the media, and other

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institutions; she also led the Fund's work on surveillance and related policies, and oversaw large IMF programs, such as those for Argentina and Ukraine.

As Chief Economist, she steered 13 releases of the World Economic Outlook, co-authored the "Pandemic Paper" which led to the creation of the Multilateral Task Force made up of the leadership of the IMF, World Bank, WTO, and WHO to help end the pandemic, and co-created the new Integrated Policy Framework to advice member countries on issues of macroeconomic and financial stability.

Born in India, Gopinath is now a U.S. citizen. She did Ph.D. in economics from Princeton University. After earning a B.A. from Lady Shri Ram College, she got an M.A. degree at the prestigious Delhi School of Economics in the early 1990s, when India was facing an economic crisis. This had a compelling impact on her and fuelled her interest in international finance and economics only continued to grow. She also has an M.A. degree

from Washington University.

Gopinath went on to serve as a John Zwaanstra Professor of International Studies and of Economics at Harvard University's economics department (2005-22) prior to her stint as Assistant Professor of Economics at the University of Chicago's Booth School of Business (2001-05). Her research was focused on International Finance and Macroeconomics, specifically on dollar dominance, exchange rates, trade and investment, international financial crises, monetary policy and debt. Gopinath has been widely cited and published in many leading economics journals on subjects like exchange rates, trade and investment, international financial crises, monetary policy, debt, and emerging market crises.

In 2019, Foreign Policy ranked her as one of the Top Global Thinkers; in 2014, she was named one of the top 25 economists under 45 by the IMF and in 2011 she was chosen a Young Global Leader (YGL) by the World Economic Forum.